Sushant Singh

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Education

Ph.D., Economics (Econometrics and Quantitative Economics) Expected 2027
University of Oklahoma, USA
Dissertation: "Three essays on food sovereignty, pollution havens, and international sanctions"
Committee: Firat Demir (chair), Pallab Ghosh, Jayash Paudel, Annabel Ipsen

M.Sc., Economics (Economic Policy) 2018
University of Neuchâtel, Switzerland
Advisor: Jean-Marie Grether

B.Com Hons. (Finance and Investment) 2014
Christ University, India

Employment

Graduate Assistant Aug 2021–present
University of Oklahoma

National Consultant March 2018–July 2021
International Trade Center (UN/WTO)

Research Assistant Oct 2017–Jan 2018
Institute of Economic Research at Neuchâtel (IRENE)

Research Interests

International Economics, Development Economics, Environmental Economics.

Job Market Paper

"**Structural adjustments and food sovereignty**" [**link**]

In this paper I study the effects of IMF program participation and associated policy conditions, known as 'conditionalities,' on food self-sufficiency of IMF members for the period of 1980-2019. In the empirical analysis, I employ a compound instrumental variable approach within a system of three equations, estimated using maximum likelihood. After accounting for confounding economic and climatic factors and addressing selection bias, I find no robust evidence that IMF program participation has any effect on food self-sufficiency. In contrast, program conditions have a significant effect on food self sufficiency. Based on point estimates, I find that each additional binding IMF condition reduces the food self-sufficiency ratio by 0.0128 percentage points. This is driven by structural policy reforms. Disaggregating conditions by policy area, the findings suggest that IMF conditionality pertaining to fiscal policies may enhance food self-sufficiency. However, IMF conditionality pertaining to institutional reforms, state owned enterprise privatization reform and pricing hinders food self-sufficiency.

Research Papers

Working Papers:

[1] "How sanctions shape the carbon footprint of global trade?" [**link**]

[2] "Revisiting the pollution haven hypothesis and trade-embodied emissions: Accounting for global value chains."

Grants, Fellowships & Awards

Alexander J. Kondonassis Award for research in Development Economics (x2) 2023 & 2025
University of Oklahoma

Dodge Family College of Arts and Sciences Dissertation Fellowship 2025
University of Oklahoma ($11,845)

Graduate Student Senate Conference Grant 2024
University of Oklahoma ($600)

Dodge Family College of Arts and Sciences Travel Grant 2024
University of Oklahoma ($750)

Conference & Seminar Presentations

† Session Chair; * Presenter & Discussant.

2026: Midwest Economics Association - MEA - 90th Annual Meeting* (Chicago, Illinois), Allied Social Sciences Association - ASSA - 2026 Annual Meeting† (Philadelphia, Pennsylvania)

2025: Southern Economic Association - SEA - 95th Annual Meeting* (Tampa, Florida), North American Regional Science Council - NARSC - 72nd Annual Meeting* (Denver, Colorado), Missouri Valley Economic Association - MVEA - 62nd Annual Meeting* (Kansas City, Missouri)

2024: North American Regional Science Council - NARSC - 71st Annual Meeting† (New Orleans, Louisiana), Missouri Valley Economic Association - MVEA - 61st Annual Meeting* (Kansas City, Missouri), OU PhD Econ Conference -OPEC (Norman, Oklahoma)

2023: OU PhD Econ Conference -OPEC (Norman, Oklahoma)

Teaching Experience

University of Oklahoma

- ECON 1113 Principles of Macroeconomics (Undergraduate) – Summer 2024, Summer 2023
- ECON 1123 Principles of Microeconomics (Undergraduate) – Winter 2023-24

Apex College (Pokhara University), Nepal

- ECO 101 Introductory Microeconomics (BBA, Undergraduate) – June 2019–July 2021
- ECO 201 Introductory Macroeconomics (BBA, Undergraduate) – June 2019–July 2021

Islington College (London Metropolitian University), Nepal

- EC5002NI International Business and World Markets (BBA, Undergraduate) – Sep 2018-Feb 2019
- EC4009NI Corporate Environment (BBA, Undergraduate) – Sep 2018-Feb 2019

Skills

Coding Expertise: Stata, R, LaTeX
Coding Experience: Julia, ArcGIS, Python, MATLAB, Git, Mathematica
Languages: English (fluent), Nepali (native), Hindi (fluent), French (basic)

Service & Professional Activities

Memberships: American Economic Association (2025-present), Southern Economic Association (2025-present), Regional Science Association International (2024-present)

References

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Assistant Professor
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Samantha R. Johnson (Teaching)
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